Primary research.

Fifteen hours at the 24-hour open house. Twenty-plus founder conversations. Eight structured interviews on a ten-question script, three fully transcribed — these eight are the ones that matter.

FOUNDER	THE KEY POINT	PAIN #1	TOOLS PAID	WOULD PAY
Shah Rukh Comic universe · 5y GTM	"Distribution is the central nervous system of any founder's journey." AI outreach = 40-50% manpower saved. Founders fail on unclear ICP, wrong channel, no founder brand. GTM consultants now $700-1,000/hr.	Outbound	0	~$200/mo
Sai Karan LazyTyper	"Scripts are the headache" — videos are easy, writing isn't. Launches on Product Hunt, Peerlist, five subreddits, X. Built his own agent (Lara) for X instead of paying for tools. Wants AEO maintained weekly.	Content — scripts	0 · built own	$10-15 (others $100+)
Vihar Dinebees · 10K downloads	Pain: finding the right creators. Happy for AI to draft 20 personal messages — with approval: "in India, public posting needs human review." AEO "very willing" once explained. Max 1-2 subscriptions ever. Signed for a free service month.	Content — creators	0	₹1.5-2K/mo
Sidhant CareKin	Distribution and positioning are his biggest bottleneck. Learned the tools exist from this interview. "I would actually buy it."	Positioning	0	₹2K stated buyer
Stazey founder Airbnb alternative	Loved the content engine. Reddit + LinkedIn posting is the draw — automating it "alone is worth it."	Content — Reddit, LinkedIn	0	₹1.5-3K/mo
Vikas XEO Rank · AEO agency	Expert validation: AEO is monitor-first, ongoing weekly work — not a one-time fix. Add SEO tracking to the optics engine.	Domain expert	Runs agency	—
Prithvi Community founder	"Tools are separate ingredients in a kitchen. Braino is the chef — one dish, no juggling apps." Backs voice-first Jarvis positioning. Human-in-loop is a must.	Tool juggling	0 · knew, never used	₹3K/mo
Eighth Verbal notes	Same pattern — distribution pain, no tools, content-first.	Distribution	0	—

8 / 8	0 / 8	8 / 8	8 / 8	3	₹1,500-3,000
distribution pain	pay for any tool	AEO interest	demand an approval gate	stated buyers	India band, per month

The other twelve-plus conversations.

Every founder shown Braino asked to try it — the 100% trial-interest pattern held. Consensus: GTM is learnable from frameworks, but distribution is "street smartness." Nobody named a tool they pay for. Zero contradicting signal.

Five findings.

Distribution is the pain, 8/8. Zero tools paid for — greenfield; Braino is the founder's first system, not a replacement. Content beats outbound as pain #1. AEO excites everyone, and an expert confirms it's weekly work. Autonomy must be approval-gated — every founder said so.

The union, and the union workflow.

Overlay all eight founders' weeks. Whatever repeats is the union — and the union, wired together, is the machine below.

WEEKLY ACTIVITY	WHO DOES / WANTS IT	IN UNION?
Content creation + posting	7/8 — scripts (Sai), creators (Vihar), Stazey, Prithvi, Shah Rukh's channel flooding	Yes — core
Platform presence — Reddit, LinkedIn, X	6/8 — Sai (X + subreddits, built Lara for X), Stazey (Reddit + LinkedIn), Shah Rukh (Reddit, Discord, FB), Vihar (IG, Reddit planned) + the documented r/buildinpublic grind	Yes — core
AEO / AI visibility	8/8 once explained — Vikas does it professionally	Yes — core
Personalized outreach	4/8 — Shah Rukh (40-50% saving), Sai, Vihar, Sidhant	Yes — gated
Research / listening	3/8 — Sai built Lara for it	Partial — feeds content
Inbound calls / paid ads	0/8 and 2/8 — Vihar called inbound irrelevant	No — cut

Union = content + Reddit/LinkedIn/X presence + AEO + gated outreach → roughly 80% of every founder's distribution week.

The full machine

Chef metaphor (Prithvi) · approval inbox 8/8 · engines = union

ENGINE 1

Content

Scripts (Sai) · creators (Vihar) · Reddit + LinkedIn (Stazey) · X (Sai)

ENGINE 2

Optics, AEO + SEO

Weekly monitor-first (Vikas) · citations churn ~23%/mo

ENGINE 3

Outbound

40-50% saving (Shah Rukh) · email + LinkedIn DMs · gate 8/8

Secondary research, and the competition.

What the internet confirms — every claim sourced — and why nobody occupies Braino's seat.

Building is solved. Distribution is the bottleneck.

- 1 in 3 new companies in 2026 is founded by one person — AI cut dev cost ~90% and time-to-MVP ~60%. (Solo Founder Playbook 2026)
- A Product Hunt Top-5 finish now brings ~1,500 visits, not 15,000. The old launch playbook is dead.
- A VC analysis of founder forums found ONE recurring theme: distribution — not AI, not features. (FundnAI)
- The "Distribution Chasm": months of building, then launch to silence — five waitlist signups. (Before Takeoff)

The manual grind, quantified.

- Documented case: 2+ hours daily on Reddit for six months → only 2-3 usable opportunities a week. (r/buildinpublic via VibeCom)
- That's ~10 hours of grinding per handful of real conversations — across Reddit, LinkedIn and X alike.
- Value-first posts earn ~10x the engagement of promotional ones. It works — but eats time founders don't have.

The AEO shift.

- 37% of product discovery now STARTS in AI interfaces like ChatGPT and Perplexity. (Profound)
- ChatGPT referrals convert at 14-16% vs ~1.8% for Google organic — roughly 9x. (Omnibound)
- Only 18% of brands have any AI-visibility strategy — 82% are invisible by default. (Erlin, 200+ marketing leaders)
- Citations churn ~23%/month; only ~30% of brands stay visible answer-to-answer — weekly maintenance is mandatory, which makes it recurring revenue. (AirOps)
- Reddit is ~10% of AI citations; brand websites only 5-10% — multi-platform content does double duty: community reach AND AI visibility. (Semrush, 100M citations)

Competition, scored.

PLAYER	CONTENT	AEO	OUTBOUND	INBOUND	DONE-FOR-YOU	PRICE
Lovable code gen	—	—	—	—	—	$25+
Leapd "AI cofounder"	Yes	Yes	Yes	—	—	$299-999
AgentWeb	Yes	Partial	Partial	—	—	$299
Apollo + Clay	—	—	Strong	—	—	$50-100
Peec / Profound	—	Measure only	—	—	—	$99-399
Buffer / Postiz	Schedule only	—	—	—	—	$15-49
GTM consultants	Yes	Some	Yes	Some	Yes — human	$700-1,000/hr
Braino	**Yes**	**Fixes weekly**	**Gated**	**Deferred — 0/8**	**Yes — agent + FDE**	**₹1.5K-$200/mo**

Every software player sits in "you do the work." Only human consultants are done-for-you — at $700+/hr. Full-stack, done-for-you, founder-priced is an empty quadrant. That's Braino's seat.

Hands-on trial (per Bhaskar): trying Apollo, Buffer, Retell as a user today — friction notes to follow.

The open-source blueprint, and what it all means.

The union workflow mapped to a stack we can wire this month — then the synthesis and the price.

JOB	THE AGENT DOES	OPEN-SOURCE / STACK	WHEN
Glue / orchestration	Routes tasks, schedules runs, holds the approval queue	n8n (self-hosted, OSS) spine + LLM API brain	First
Content	Writes in the founder's tone; platform-fit versions for Reddit, LinkedIn, X, IG	LLM writer + Postiz (OSS scheduler) for LinkedIn/X/IG; Reddit via PRAW	Wk 1-2
Research feed	Listens for niche keywords, surfaces threads worth joining	Reddit API keyword listeners, F5Bot-style, self-built	Wk 1-2
Optics — AEO + SEO	Weekly buyer-question checks, scorecard, fix drafts	Scheduled LLM queries + OSS SERP scrapers; fixes ship via content engine	Wk 3-4
Outbound	Researches targets, drafts 1:1 messages, tracks replies	Lead scrapers / Apollo free tier + LLM personalization + SMTP; LinkedIn DMs assisted	Wk 5-6
Approval layer	One inbox — approve, edit, reject; nothing posts without it	n8n wait-nodes + Braino app: voice in, tap out	Ships with v1
Inbound	AI calls and chat	Retell / Bland class	Deferred — 0/8 asked

This exact wiring runs by hand for Dinebees first — **free service month, signed** *— then we productize what repeats. Cost stays near zero through the service phase.*

Synthesis.

Founders can build in days but can't distribute. They pay for zero tools — existing tools serve marketers with budgets, not pre-revenue founders. So they grind manually across Reddit, LinkedIn and X, or launch to silence, while discovery moves to AI answers and 82% of brands have no strategy for it. **The white space: be the founder's first distribution system** — one voice-commanded companion that writes in their tone, keeps them visible in AI answers weekly, and drafts personal outreach. Every action approval-gated. Priced for pre-revenue.

Pricing, anchored to stated numbers.

TIER	PRICE	ANCHOR
India pre-revenue starter	₹1,499-2,999/mo	CareKin ₹2K · Stazey ₹1.5-3K · Prithvi ₹3K · Vihar ₹1.5-2K
Global solo-founder Pro	$49-99/mo	"A normal founder would pay $100+" — Sai Karan
Revenue-stage / GTM	$200+/mo	Shah Rukh's ceiling; consultants at $700-1,000/hr
FDE service — run it for you	Free month → ₹25-50K/mo	Dinebees signed; YC 2026: "sell the service"

Founders don't need another tool — they have none. They need one companion that does content, visibility, and outreach for them, with their approval, at a price they can say yes to before revenue. That's Braino Foundry.